ERA 14

The Progressive Movement

1890 – 1920

Muckrakers · democratic reform · social justice

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How did reformers try to fix the problems of an industrial, urban America?

KEY TERMS

Muckrakers · the initiative, referendum & recall · the 17th Amendment · women's suffrage

ALIGNED TO

CED Topic 7.4 · AMSCO Ch. 7.4

FIXING AN INDUSTRIAL NATION

An Age of Reform

What Was Progressivism?

I

Curb Big Business

Rein in the power of trusts, monopolies, and corrupt corporations.

II

Clean Up Government

Root out political machines and return power to the people.

III

Protect People

Use **active government** and expertise to safeguard workers, consumers, and the poor.

The Muckrakers

- Investigative journalists—dubbed '**muckrakers**'—exposed corruption and abuse.
- Magazines like *McClure's* reached mass audiences.
- Their exposés turned public outrage into pressure for reform.

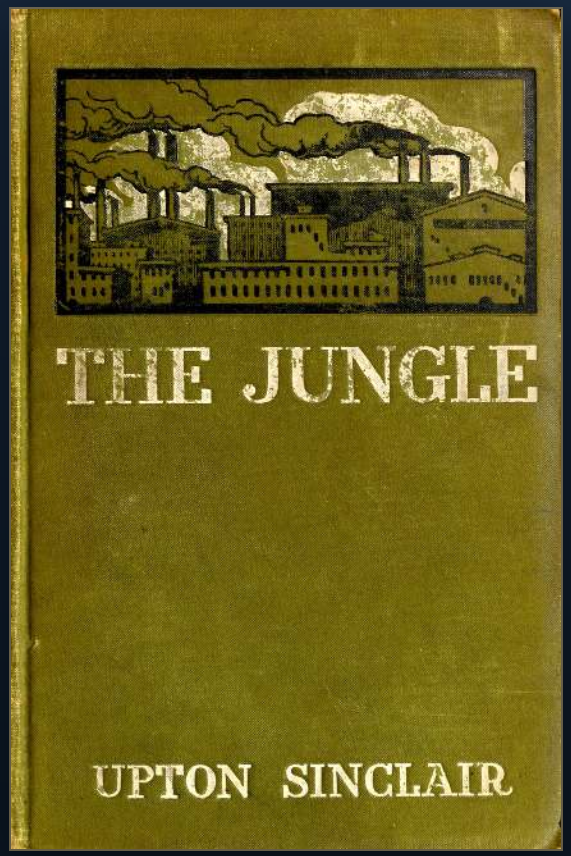


Exposing the Nation's Ills

Each exposé fueled a Progressive campaign

MUCKRAKER	EXPOSÉ	TARGET
Jacob Riis	***How the Other Half Lives***	Slum & tenement misery
Ida Tarbell	*History of* ***Standard Oil***	Monopoly & ruthless business
Lincoln Steffens	***The Shame of the Cities***	Corrupt political machines
Upton Sinclair	***The Jungle***	Filth in the meatpacking industry

The Jungle & Consumer Protection



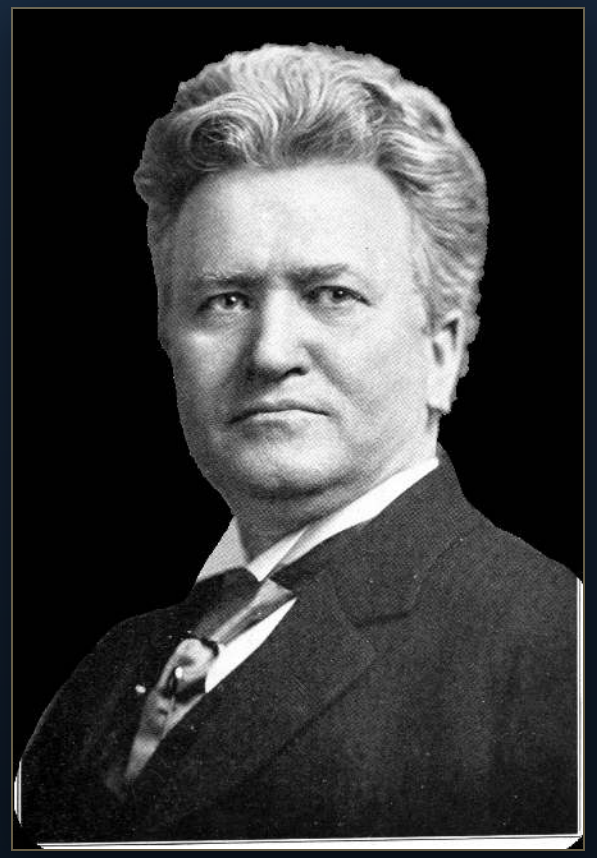
- **Upton Sinclair's *The Jungle*** (1906) revealed horrifying conditions in meatpacking.
- Public disgust forced Congress to act.
- The **Pure Food and Drug Act** and **Meat Inspection Act** (1906) protected consumers.

SECTION

Making Democracy Work

Returning Power to the People

- The **initiative**, **referendum**, and **recall** gave voters direct control.
- The **direct primary** and **secret ballot** weakened party bosses.
- The **17th Amendment** (1913) let citizens elect U.S. senators directly.
- **Robert La Follette's 'Wisconsin Idea'** became a model for the nation.



SECTION

The Pursuit of Social Justice

Votes for Women



- Suffragists in **NAWSA** marched, lobbied, and organized for the vote.
- Western states led the way before national change came.
- The **19th Amendment** (1920) finally guaranteed women's **suffrage**.

More Crusades—and Real Limits

I

Social Work

Settlement houses like Jane Addams's Hull House served immigrants and the poor.

II

Temperance

The **WCTU** and allies won the **18th Amendment**—national Prohibition.

III

The Limits

Progressivism largely excluded Black Americans, who built their own groups like the **NACW**.

The Dark Side of Reform

TERM

Eugenics & scientific racism

Pseudoscience claiming that some races and "unfit" people were biologically inferior. Some Progressives embraced it, and it led to forced-sterilization laws (upheld in Buck v. Bell, 1927) and the immigration quotas of the 1920s.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

The Progressive Movement

1. **Muckrakers** like Riis, Tarbell, Steffens, and Sinclair exposed abuses—driving laws like the **Pure Food and Drug Act**.

2. Reformers made democracy more direct through the **initiative**, **referendum**, **recall**, and the **17th Amendment**.

3. The movement won **women's suffrage (19th Amendment)** and **Prohibition**—but largely left **Black Americans** behind.

DISCUSS & APPLY

The Progressive Movement

AP HISTORICAL REASONING PRACTICE

CAUSATION

Explain how the **muckrakers** shaped public demand for reform.

COMPARISON

Compare Progressive efforts to reform **democracy** with efforts to achieve **social justice**. Which went further?

CONTINUITY & CHANGE

How did the fight for **women's suffrage** build on earlier reform movements?

Up next — **Lesson 34: Progressivism in Power** (TR, Taft, Wilson & the amendments)